



Required Capstone Project: Module 9

Due Aug 5 by 11:59pm**Points** None**Available** after Jul 22 at 12am

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Learning Outcomes Addressed

- Understand how AI, GenAI and Agentic AI work and where they apply in business.
- Use prompts effectively for analysis, decision-making and content generation.
- Map business workflows and identify where AI can drive automation and efficiency.
- Evaluate AI opportunities using feasibility, ROI and impact criteria.
- Build AI adoption roadmaps aligned to business goals and KPIs.
- Apply data governance, privacy and ethical AI principles.

Phase 4 – Strategy & Industry Context

Milestone 9: Strategic Validation & Investment Brief

Estimated Effort: 1.5 Hours

Objective

Organisations often identify **multiple potential AI use cases**, but not all initiatives should be implemented.

Successful AI adoption requires leaders to prioritise initiatives based on:

- implementation feasibility
- expected return on investment (ROI)
- operational and regulatory risks
- long-term strategic value

In practice, organisations evaluate **several competing AI initiatives** before deciding which ones to prioritise.

In this module, you will validate whether the **AI solution developed in your capstone project** represents the best strategic investment compared with alternative AI opportunities.

You will compare **three possible AI initiatives**, including your capstone use case, and justify why your selected initiative should be prioritised.

This exercise reflects a **typical executive decision process** used in AI strategy and digital transformation planning.

How This Connects to Earlier Modules

Throughout the capstone, you developed an AI solution step by step.

- **Module 2** – Analysed the current workflow and risks
- **Module 3** – Designed prompts supporting workflow tasks
- **Module 5** – Redesigned the AI-enabled workflow
- **Modules 6–8** – Designed agent architecture, governance, and autonomous execution

In this module, you step back and evaluate a strategic question:

Is this the best AI investment compared with other opportunities available to the organisation?

Note: This is a required assignment and counts towards programme completion.

Task Overview

Create a **Strategic Validation & Investment Brief** that compares **three possible AI initiatives**.

These must include:

1. **Your capstone AI use case**
2. **Two alternative AI initiatives**

You will compare these initiatives across four strategic dimensions:

- Feasibility
- Return on Investment (ROI)
- Risk
- Strategic Impact

You will then determine **which initiative the organisation should prioritise** and explain why.

Finally, you will identify the **investment requirements and organisational changes** needed to implement the selected initiative.

Selecting the Two Alternative AI Initiatives

In addition to your **capstone AI use case**, you must identify **two alternative AI initiatives** that an organisation could realistically consider.

These alternatives should:

- belong to the **same business function or operational domain** as your capstone workflow
- represent **different ways AI could create value** in that domain
- be **credible initiatives that organisations might actually implement**

This approach reflects real-world AI strategy discussions where leaders must choose between **several competing investment options**.

Example (Illustrative)

If your capstone project focuses on **AI-enabled customer support automation**, your three initiatives might be:

Initiative	Description
AI Support Automation (<i>Capstone</i>)	AI agents respond to customer support enquiries
AI Sentiment Analysis	AI analyses customer feedback to identify satisfaction trends
AI Knowledge Base Assistant	AI helps support staff retrieve relevant documentation

All three initiatives relate to **customer service operations**, but solve **different problems**.

Step 1 — Describe the Three AI Initiatives

Start by briefly describing the **three AI initiatives** you will compare.

Include:

- the business problem addressed
- how AI would be applied

- the expected organisational benefit

Descriptions should be **brief but clear**.

Example (Illustrative)

Initiative	Description
AI Invoice Processing	AI extracts and validates invoice data automatically
AI Fraud Detection	AI identifies suspicious financial transactions
AI Financial Reporting Assistant	AI generates automated financial summaries

Step 2 — Evaluate Feasibility

Feasibility measures **how practical it is for the organisation to implement the initiative**.

Consider factors such as:

- data availability
 - technical complexity
 - integration with existing systems
 - organisational readiness
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Example Considerations

Initiative	Feasibility Considerations
Invoice Processing AI	Existing invoice data and ERP integration available
Fraud Detection AI	Requires large labelled datasets
Reporting Assistant AI	Requires integration with financial reporting tools

Step 3 — Evaluate Return on Investment (ROI)

ROI estimates the **economic value generated by the initiative**.

Consider:

- operational cost reductions
 - productivity improvements
 - revenue growth potential
 - scalability of the solution
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Example

Initiative	Potential ROI
Invoice Processing AI	Reduced manual processing costs
Fraud Detection AI	Reduced financial losses
Reporting Assistant AI	Faster financial reporting cycles

Step 4 — Evaluate Risk

AI initiatives may introduce operational or regulatory risks.

Consider risks such as:

- incorrect AI outputs
 - data privacy concerns
 - compliance issues
 - reputational impact
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Example

Initiative	Key Risks
Invoice Processing AI	Incorrect data extraction
Fraud Detection AI	False positives affecting customers
Reporting Assistant AI	Incorrect financial summaries

Step 5 — Evaluate Strategic Impact

Strategic impact measures how strongly the initiative contributes to **long-term organisational capability or competitive advantage**.

Consider whether the initiative:

- improves core operational capabilities
- strengthens customer experience
- enables new digital capabilities
- differentiates the organisation from competitors

Example

Initiative	Strategic Impact
Invoice Processing AI	Improves finance efficiency
Fraud Detection AI	Strengthens financial security
Reporting Assistant AI	Improves financial insight and decision-making

Step 6 — Use a Simple Scoring Matrix

To support prioritisation, you may assign **scores to each initiative** across the four evaluation criteria.

Example scoring scale:

1 = Low

3 = Moderate

5 = High

Example Scoring Matrix

Initiative	Feasibility	ROI	Risk	Strategic Impact	Total Score
Invoice Processing AI	4	4	3	3	14
Fraud Detection AI	3	5	3	5	16
Reporting Assistant AI	5	3	2	3	13

The scoring matrix helps provide a **structured basis for decision-making**.

Step 7 — Make a Prioritisation Decision

Based on your analysis, identify **which initiative the organisation should prioritise**.

Explain:

- why the selected initiative provides the strongest value
 - how the decision balances ROI, feasibility, and risk
 - how it supports long-term strategic goals
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Example (Illustrative)

Although invoice automation provides quick efficiency gains, the organisation should prioritise **AI fraud detection**, as it protects financial assets and strengthens long-term risk management capabilities.

Step 8 — Identify Investment and Change Management Needs

Finally, outline the **resources required to implement the selected initiative**.

Consider:

- technology investments
- AI infrastructure or tools
- employee training
- workflow redesign
- governance frameworks

You should also consider **change management challenges**, such as:

- employee adoption
 - process adjustments
 - organisational resistance
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Required Output Structure

Your **Strategic Validation & Investment Brief** should include:

1. Description of Three AI Initiatives

Brief description of the capstone use case and two alternative initiatives.

2. Strategic Comparison Framework

Evaluation across feasibility, ROI, risk, and strategic impact.

3. Scoring Matrix (Optional but Recommended)

A simple scoring framework supporting your decision.

4. Final Prioritisation Decision

Explanation of which initiative should be implemented first.

5. Investment and Change Management Considerations

Outline resources and organisational changes required.

Practical Tips

Choose Realistic Alternatives

Your alternative initiatives should represent **credible AI opportunities within the same organisational domain**.

Avoid unrelated projects.

Think Like an Executive

Executives prioritise initiatives that deliver:

- measurable financial impact
- long-term strategic advantage
- manageable implementation risk

Focus on Strategic Value

The strongest AI initiatives are those that **transform core capabilities**, not just automate isolated tasks.

Avoid These Common Mistakes

- ✗ Selecting unrealistic or futuristic AI projects
- ✗ Comparing initiatives from unrelated departments
- ✗ Ignoring implementation complexity
- ✗ Focusing only on technical capability rather than business value

Successful AI strategies balance **technology, economics, and organisational readiness**.

Submission

Before submitting your **Strategic Validation & Investment Brief**, confirm that you have included:

- ✓ Three AI initiatives (including your capstone use case)
- ✓ Strategic comparison across feasibility, ROI, risk, and strategic impact
- ✓ A prioritisation decision
- ✓ Investment and change management considerations

Instructions:

- Use the same document that you downloaded in Module 1 and include your responses.
- We recommend you add additional text boxes or slides (if needed) for each milestone task to ensure that your responses are documented in a proper format.
- The document will gradually grow as you complete each capstone milestone. The final submission occurs at the end of Module 14.

Grading Rubric

Maximum Points: 15

Criteria	Full Points	0 Points
Identification of AI Initiatives (3 points)	The submission identifies three AI initiatives, including the capstone use case, and describes the business objective and strategic relevance of each initiative. (3 points)	Three AI initiatives, including the capstone use case, are not identified. (0 points)
Strategic Comparison of AI Initiatives (6 points)	The submission compares the three AI initiatives using strategic criteria such as feasibility, ROI, implementation risk, and strategic impact, and presents an evaluation to support decision-making. (6 points)	Strategic comparison across feasibility, ROI, implementation risk, and strategic impact is missing. (0 points)
Prioritisation Decision (3 points)	The submission justifies the prioritisation of one AI initiative using appropriate business reasoning, strategic alignment, and expected organisational value. (3 points)	Prioritisation decision or supporting justification is missing. (0 points)
Investment and Change Management Considerations (3 points)	The submission explains the investment considerations, resource requirements, stakeholder engagement, and change management activities required to successfully implement the prioritised AI initiative. (3 points)	Investment considerations or change management activities are missing. (0 points)

Why this Step Matters

AI adoption is not just a technical decision — it is a **strategic investment decision**.

Organisations must determine:

- which initiatives deliver the greatest value
- which projects should be prioritised
- how limited resources should be allocated

The ability to **evaluate and prioritise AI opportunities strategically** is a critical capability for leaders involved in **digital transformation and AI strategy**.

In the next module, you will explore how **AI adoption varies across industries**, and how organisations adapt AI strategies to their **specific operational environments**.